

THE BIG DROP

A B-52F drops a string of bombs over South Vietnam in 1965. The B-52F could carry 51,750lb (23,500kg) of bombs, but this capacity was dwarfed by the modified “Big Belly” B-52Ds introduced later in the war, whose maximum load was almost 60,000lb (27,000kg).



SCENE OF DEVASTATION

The devastation wrought by military action in South Vietnam, as here in the Cholon district of Saigon after the 1968 Tet offensive, was often the result of artillery fire. But it was the use of air power that became the focus of antiwar sentiment in the United States, with the B-52 an especially demonized aircraft.

“The bombers hide above the clouds. The whistle and explosion of bombs thunder in every corner of the forest.”

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